COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

# Chief of Staff at Novilla Pharmaceuticals Sees Didero as Essential for Cost Savings and Efficiency in Clinical Trials

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SMART SUMMARY

## Summary

The interview covers the expert's experience implementing and using Didero for procurement and supply chain management in a clinical-stage pharmaceutical company. **Discussion topics include cost savings,** operational efficiencies, AI-driven automation, and the platform's impact on preventing delays in clinical trials.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Chief of Staff and Head of Operations at a clinical-stage pharmaceutical company, responsible for procurement operations, supply chain, and supporting preclinical and clinical trials.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- The expert is highly satisfied with Didero, viewing it as a critical tool **that has replaced expensive consultants and improved** operational efficiency.
- They believe Didero is scalable and plan to continue using it as **the company grows, emphasizing its role in preventing costly delays in clinical trials**.
- The expert is impressed by the AI-driven automation and suggestions, noting that **the product has improved over time** and is considered mission-critical to daily operations.

TAKEAWAYS

- Didero replaced a consultant **who managed procurement and supply chain tasks, resulting in significant cost savings** (from $120,000/year for a consultant to $30,000-$60,000/year for Didero).
- Implementation of Didero was quick and seamless, taking only a few days to set up and about a week and a half to fully transition from the consultant.
- Didero automates and streamlines communication with vendors, invoice approvals, and document management, integrating with tools like Google Drive, Dropbox, and email.
- **The platform is particularly valuable for managing complex pharmaceutical supply chains, including cross-border shipments and compliance with GLP standards, helping to avoid delays** that could cost six figures.
- **Didero's AI-driven suggestions and automation have improved over time,** and the expert finds the customer support responsive and helpful, especially for sourcing hard-to-find ingredients.

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## Expert Bio

Chief of Staff, Corporate Development at Novilla Pharmaceuticals. The expert is a customer of Didero and is a key decision-maker in the evaluation process. Chief of Staff, Corporate Development at Novilla Pharmaceuticals. Former Co-Founder, Head of Growth & Acquisition Marketing at Calm Canine Academy. Prior the expert was Operations Executive at Ollie, leaving in December 2019. The expert was responsible for sourcing and supply chain, production and packaging, contract management, fulfillment and shipping, canine care (customer success), influencer marketing, data analysis, and reporting

## Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00
Thank you for speaking with us about Didero. You mentioned, I think to the network that you're currently a customer of Didero. Is that correct?

Expert 00:00:09
Yes, correct.

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Client 00:00:11
Okay. Can you just give me a very basic background, the company you work for, what industry you're in, how big it is, etc., and your role within it?

Expert 00:00:22
Yeah. I'm chief of staff and head of operations at Novilla Pharmaceuticals. It is a clinical-stage pharmaceutical company. We have about eight full-time employees and 30-40 active consultants.

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Client 00:00:37
How many full-time employees?

Expert 00:00:40
Eight. We have 30-40 active 1099 consultants who put in two to three hours a week.

---

Client 00:00:48
When you say Didero, what does the product do? Just to check that we're talking about the same company.

Expert 00:00:55
Yeah. It basically helps us with supply chain procurement, accounts payable, communication with vendors, etc.

---

Client 00:01:03
Got it. I think we're talking about the same company. I'm interested in the whole journey of how you discovered Didero, what kind of problem were you trying to solve, etc.? Maybe if you could give me the whole story there.

Expert 00:01:20
Yeah. I basically manage all the procurement operations, supply chain, all the operations behind our preclinical and clinical trials. I got a cold call for a company called Prendio and they basically said they could automate a lot of what I was doing in regards to ordering, approvals, and just payments. I took the demo and then Prendio, basically, they said they could automate all those things.

**I was really disappointed by the demo** because even though they said they were using AI, it looked like they just had a really active team, doing the requests and they were working on the AI. I'm part of a chief of staff network, and in that chief of staff network, I was talking to another chief of staff and they recommended Didero. That's how I found out about Didero.

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Client 00:02:08

Got it. Just so **I understand, the extent of the procurement pain** you're dealing with, can you just give me a sense of, I don't know exactly how a clinical-stage pharmaceutical company works, but are you buying a lot of supplies? Do you have lots of suppliers? Why do you even need a software solution to do it rather than just a few emails?

Expert 00:02:29

Yeah. Before Didero, we actually had a consultant who charged us about $7,000-$12,000 a month doing what Didero does, which is we communicate with a lot of different vendors and everything needs to be transported in a GLP, so good laboratory practice method, in order to qualify for FDA clinical trials. That's already a pain. In order to cross borders, we order a lot of our stuff from China and India and Australia. **It's a pain** to cross multiple borders, especially getting into the United States with GLP methods. That's really why we had a consultant doing it for us and Didero basically replaced that.

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Client 00:03:11

Got it. You had looked at Prendio, did you evaluate other solutions for the same problem you were trying to solve that you ultimately got Didero for?

Expert 00:03:22

Yeah. I also looked at, someone recommended Zip and someone recommended Levelpath. Zip ended up just being a system of record for spending and it basically, all it did was like, "Oh, this is being bought. Can someone approve it?" It's not for things that you need. It's more for very regular items. You can't do the sophisticated processes. It's more so like, "Oh, I'm buying this. Is it approved?" That wasn't very helpful.

For Levelpath, it's another one I looked at. Levelpath, it wasn't specialized enough for us. The SKUs that were in there were paper, laptops, pencils. It doesn't actually look at what our supply chain is. It just looks at what we normally buy for our office. It also was more of a system of record, but they both say this AI.

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Client 00:04:19

Got it. When were you carrying out this evaluation? Ultimately, when did you decide to buy Didero? When did you actually sign the contract to Didero?

Expert 00:04:30

March of this year.

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Client 00:04:32

Got it. Remind me what you guys do. Do you make drugs or do you make supplements or what kind of products?

Expert 00:04:41

We make pharmaceutical drugs while we're going through that same process for pharma drugs.

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Client 00:04:46

Got it. When did you guys launch with Didero? When did you go live?

Expert 00:04:53

March. It was very easy.

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Client 00:04:58

Understood. The implementation was very easy you said, what did it entail?

Expert 00:05:04

Yeah. Basically, it reminded me of the implementation of Rippling, the HR software. Basically, I just added them as an accountant to Justworks and I added them as an accountant to bill.com and then our team individually signed into Didero using the Google sign in. Within, I would say, three days, all the information was in there and organized, **which is pretty incredible**.



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Client 00:05:28
Did you do any proof of concept or you went from demo conversations, straight into the full implementation as you described it?

Expert 00:05:36
Yes, that's exactly what we did. We just went into full implementation after.

Client 00:05:44
Okay. Does Didero connect to any of your systems or how does it get all the information into the system?

Expert 00:05:52
Yeah, we have a pretty simple tech stack where we really just use Google Docs, Google spreadsheets, and Justworks, Gmail. It basically pulls in all of our emails from our different emails. If we put in a domain, it'll show all the emails from every individual person who has communicated with that domain. For our documents, it integrates with Dropbox and Google Drive. It pulls in those documents and all the attachments in our email, and it summarizes it in a line for us, and says who was the last one who updated it in one place.

Client 00:06:26
Got it. What was the specific use case that you started with on Didero? What exactly were you using the product for?

Expert 00:06:36
Yeah. I was attracted to Didero first just by their unified inbox. It's like Superhuman, team inbox. I was most interested by the inbox. It started suggesting things, like Didero started suggesting things like, "Oh, we see you emailed this person every Monday. Do you want us to automatically drop this email?" I would press yes.

Client 00:06:59
Just a question for you, when you're talking about, are these emails between you and your colleagues or between you and your suppliers?

Expert 00:07:08
Both.

Client 00:07:09
Okay. I'm trying to understand if the use cases like Superhuman you would use for any email with anyone, client, colleague, supplier, whatever. I'm trying to understand if the use case for Didero is generic or if you were using it for the supply chain or procurement stuff.

Expert 00:07:26
It connects to both your employees and your suppliers, but you only see the employee emails if a supplier is copied on it.

Client 00:07:34
Got it. It somehow can recognize who is a supplier and who is a colleague.

Expert 00:07:40
Yep. It did that for us.

Client 00:07:43
Got it. Just to be clear, your primary use case was what? You said, you were drawn to it for the unified inbox, but what kind of work did you want to get done? What kind of work did you get end up getting done?


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Expert 00:07:59

Yeah. I wanted to replace the consultant we were paying so much money for. What that consultant did was basically check in with vendors like, "Oh, was this sent on the right date? Was this sent in the right way?" Confirming with the next vendor, "Did you receive it?" Making sure that they sent the correct thing. That was the first thing that they did, that Didero replaced.

The second thing they did was getting it across customs. Didero is really good at being familiar with GLP methods for pharma as well as getting stuff across borders. They just have a good network of, our consultant was one customs broker, but they have a good network of other customs brokers that can get stuff across the border. They just have the right connections. They know what's missing.

That has saved us. I think the easy thing to see is that we've replaced our consultant with something much cheaper. The biggest cost of saving that my founder loves is that **it hasn't delayed our clinical trials**. It's helped us make our clinical trials go faster.

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Client 00:09:05

Got it. Let's take these one at a time. First, the consultant replacement. Could you describe more in depth the activities that the consultant was carrying out? First of all, how many vendors are you guys dealing with, 10, 100, 1,000, 10,000? Just order of magnitude. What was this consultant doing with them?

Expert 00:09:31

Thirty.

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Client 00:09:32

Got it. What was the consultant doing, day in and day out? Was he placing orders, sending purchase orders, chasing them?

Expert 00:09:42

Yeah, sending purchase orders, double checking things had been sent, making sure they had been sent at the right temperature, making sure they weren't in transit for too long. There's just a lot of esoteric GLP rules that we had to follow, which he made sure our shipments were following.

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Client 00:09:58

Got it. Do you guys have an ERP system?

Expert 00:10:03

We do not have ERP.

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Client 00:10:05

Do you have an accounting system? You said you have, obviously the Google Suite and an inbox.

Expert 00:10:14

Yeah, we have systems for accounting?

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Client 00:10:16

Got it. You have no ERP, but you have QuickBooks, and you have no other solution that touches procurement or supply chain.

Expert 00:10:24

Correct.

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Client 00:10:26

Got it. Basically, Didero, you said, took over this consultant, but did you guys have to set up Didero somehow? Did their team help you to set the tool up so that it could, I don't know, do the right things, or was it pretty much out of the box? It could figure out we need to chase this guy. Just walk me through the transition from consultant to Didero. How long did that take to basically let go the consultant and have Didero take over this part of the workflow?



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Expert 00:10:55
Yeah, it took one and a half weeks for us to get rid of the consultant because Didero just picked up on all the conversations and was like, "Okay, you left off at here." They would draft an email to be like, "We think it's time for you to check in on this shipment." I would just send the drafted email.

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Client 00:11:14
Got it. I think I've seen a demo of Didero, so I'm just trying to map what you're saying to the demo. When you say it would draft emails, what does the interface look like? Is there a list of to do that Didero says you need to review these to do and confirm, or would Didero just autonomously, in the background, send emails without you even knowing?

Expert 00:11:36
No, it was in the inbox. There's three tabs to Didero and the first tab was your inbox, which was everyone's to-do list. The email will be drafted in there.

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Client 00:11:48
You wake up in the morning, you open Didero, you find a bunch of emails pre-drafted for you and you just need to click send?

Expert 00:11:55
Correct.

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Client 00:11:56
Got it. What other capabilities does Didero have? There is the inbox, and that one's automating the communications. In this case, Didero has mapped out who your suppliers are and which orders you also have happening because you don't have an ERP, so you don't really have a system of records for any of this data other than the inbox. Why don't you describe the features that Didero has and the main screens and the functionality as you have seen it?

Expert 00:12:25
Yeah. Do you want to go into the second thing **that would be this cost saving thing for the clinical trial**? If not, I can go into that later.

---

Client 00:12:33
I prefer parking that for a second because I think that one's a little bit more specific to you guys as a pharma company. Didero is trying to do this across industries. First, I'm interested in the general features.

Expert 00:12:46
Yeah. There are three main tabs that we use. When you log in, there's the inbox like you said that automatically drafts emails and reminds you of things. The next tab is the contractor view where you can see all your contractors. You can click into them and see who had the most recent conversation, what that conversation was about. You can even reply within Didero and it replies all to everyone. The third tab that we use is documents, where pulls in the latest updated documents from your email, Google Drive, and Dropbox, and it just summarizes what the document is and then says who updated it last.

---

Client 00:13:30
Okay. I'm sure it can pull up in any document you have on Google Drive, but is it pulling in documents related to the suppliers or the orders, or is it also pulling in random pitch text you guys have?

Expert 00:13:43
It does not pull in pitch text. It only pulls in what we have sent to suppliers or vendors.

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Client 00:13:50
Got it. It's the attachment.


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Expert 00:13:54
Yes.

Client 00:13:56
Got it. Didero basically has created for you guys a view of your suppliers, like the full list, and you can see the interactions you've had with each. You have the attachments as well and then you have the inbox. That's basically it.

Expert 00:14:12
That's correct.

Client 00:14:14
In terms of the inbox itself, can you help me understand the use cases or automations that Didero have? Actually, let's go back to what the consultant was doing for you. The consultant was sending requests for supplies, like a purchase order, double checking the things that been sent, understanding when they were getting shipped.

Is Didero able to do all of the above? What kind of actions can Didero take? Does it understand shipping timelines? If you send them a purchase order and then **they send you an invoice and there's a mismatch**, can it pick things like that up? What are the things that Didero actually does in the inbox?

Expert 00:14:55
Yeah. One example that they replaced is that we would get contractor invoices that come from everyone and then everyone on the team. When Didero picked up that, it was an invoice, it automatically made a process that was like, "Okay, this goes to our CFO to approve." Afterwards, it goes to me for processing.

Client 00:15:17
Didero reads basically all the emails from everyone and then understands which ones are about an invoice, for example. If it detects an invoice then it says, "Okay, this is an invoice." Another needs to be a process around it. It needs to be approved by the CFO or something like that. That's right?

Expert 00:15:37
Yeah. It just saw me doing that with every invoice, I think. I'm not sure how AI works. It just saw that I was sending stuff that was invoiced to our CFO and then one day a process popped up that was like, "Would you like all invoices to automatically be sent to the CFO and to Jane for approval?" I was like, "Yes." Now the invoices just come into my inbox and I just press pay and then my CFO is notified.

Client 00:16:06
The CFO gets an email or is there a separate screen where you can approve or deny invoices?

Expert 00:16:12
He gets something in Didero that says that the status is approved now.

Client 00:16:17
Okay. We never talked about the tasks screen. Is there a task screen?

Expert 00:16:26
It's the inbox screen that has the processes and the tasks. I call them tasks too.

Client 00:16:33
Got it. You can see both the inbox and also on the side, there are some tasks like approver, reject this invoice or whatever?


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Expert 00:16:42
Sorry, this is confusing. The first tab is called inbox, but it actually just has tasks. The second tab is the unified inbox. They're two separate tabs.

Client 00:16:55
There's a tasks tab, then there's an inbox, but you also said there's the contractor view.

Expert 00:17:00
Yes, there's contractor view. The contractor view is the inbox. It's the unified inbox because the inbox is sorted by contractors.

Client 00:17:12
Got it. What kind of tasks would Didero ask you guys to do, like approve this invoice or what other things would it ask you to do?

Expert 00:17:21
Yeah, sometimes things would get stuck at the border and it would notify everyone and then Didero would come up with suggestions on people to contact. Would you like to contact the suggested customs people? They would draft us an email and then that person would get pulled in. That's another process.

Client 00:17:39
Okay. There is the approval, the rejection of invoices, notification about stuff stuck at the border. What about just follow ups to suppliers to chase them on an order or checking in on a shipment, or what if there is **a shipment delay or stuff like that**? Does that even show up in tasks or it happens automatically in the background?

Expert 00:17:59
It happens in tasks. It doesn't send any emails without me pressing send. It just shows up as a task and then they drop the email and I'm like, "Oh, usually it was suppose to arrive on this day. Why hasn't it arrived yet?" It takes the thinking out for me.

Client 00:18:16
Got it. Does Didero have any capabilities with regards to, imagine that you send a purchase order to a supplier and you say, "I want to buy 1,000 pipettes," and the supplier sends you then an invoice and says, "Okay, great," or an order confirmation says, "Great, we're going to ship you 1,500 pipettes, thank you very much. This is going to be the cost." The supplier maybe made a mistake and wants to send you more. Has that ever happened either with quantity, or price, dimension, or something else? Does Didero pick things like that up or not really in your experience?

Expert 00:18:54
Yes, it does pick up the price thing. We've had that happen with the pricing because **we have very complicated purchase orders** that need to arrive by certain dates and times. **It messed** up one time with the price and Didero flagged it right away, the second the email was sent to us. That was really helpful.

Client 00:19:14
Okay. How many people are going into Didero, would you say like, it's you, the CFO?

Expert 00:19:21
Six.

Client 00:19:22
Okay. Does it also allow you to track a specific order?

Expert 00:19:27
There's no order tracker. If you click into the email thread, you can track it that way.


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Client 00:19:32
Got it. This is like the core functionality. Have I missed anything? We'll get into the pharma-specific stuff. I'm very interested in the customs point you mentioned, but in terms of what Didero does, what the AI does, is there anything you would add?

Expert 00:19:50
I've been impressed by Didero's AI multiple times. I also don't know what AI is.

Client 00:19:56
Don't worry, nobody knows.

Expert 00:19:59
Yeah. I think a really interesting thing is how they consume the information and then they're able to, like I said, realize the pricing change because **we have very complicated purchase orders**. I just don't understand how it understands. I have trouble understanding the purchase orders. To understand that, that's very impressive.

Client 00:20:20
Super interesting. Let's move on to the border stuff on the pharma specific stuff. You said your CEO or founder was very happy that **it saved you time and has not delayed the clinical trials** and helps you get customs. Help me really unpack that at a detailed level. What does it actually do? How does it do it? What's the value?

Expert 00:20:46
Yeah. It's very, very helpful for pharma companies because **the biggest cost to our clinical trials are delays** and because we have a huge burn rate. **An example of a very easy delay is the active ingredient was transported from Canada to the U.S., or let's just say domestically within the U.S., and then it was delayed for a day**, but the ice only lasts 24 hours.

We have to go in and ship the same Active again from a different site. There's a chance that that Active doesn't have enough stock, so we have to make it. The clinical trial, when we're allowed to test is a very small window because it's very backed up post-pandemic. We would have to wait for the new Active to arrive. We might miss our actual testing date. We'd have to wait two months. That two months is two months of burn rate. We have to remake a bunch of chemicals.

This has happened multiple times, even with the consultants. The way Didero helps us is basically just having another eye, a machine eye looking at all the deliveries to make sure everything is arriving on the right date and in the right temperature. Companies can spend six-figures on a clinical trial because of a small delay. Didero is amazing for that.

Client 00:22:06
Super interesting. The shipment **delays**, I can imagine how it would help you chase suppliers if it notices that or whatever that they promised a certain shipping time, but then they didn't send you a shipping confirmation and whatnot. Maybe it can pick that up. What about the temperature stuff? How does it help you with the temperature stuff?

Expert 00:22:27
Yeah. We use World Courier, which reports the temperature at every stage. I think it picks up on that.

Client 00:22:37
What does it do when it picks up the temperature.

Expert 00:22:40
We get a notification that like, "Oh, product has arrived at this stage at this time, signed off by this person at this temperature. Amount of total shipping time now has been 36 hours."


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Client 00:22:52
Okay. It just surfaces the information for you, and then you look at it and you're like, "Oh, shit. This should have been, I don't know, 24 hours instead of 36 hours," and then you act on it. It's just summarizing the information like, "Here's what your supplier promised you, here's what the shipping actually did from a temperature perspective, and here's how long it took." Is that right?

Expert 00:23:18
Correct.

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Client 00:23:19
Super interesting. My question then is, let's try to quantify the value together from Didero. It sounds like there's the component of just replacing this consultant which costed you a certain amount every month. There's the component of the savings on delays and the clinical trial. Can you help me think through the math of all of that and if your CFO came to you and said, "Justify all the money we're spending on the Didero subscription," what would you tell them?

Expert 00:23:47
Yeah. I first did the consultant math. That was around $7,000-$12,000 a month. If we say $10,000 a month, multiply it by 12, which is $120,000 a month. We were going to have to hire a second consultant soon, that would have been $240,000 a month. That's how I quantified that. Just the insurance for the clinical trial, that's hard to quantify.

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Client 00:24:16
Just to give me a sense on the value of that, you said if delay happened it could you six-figures?

Expert 00:24:22
Correct.

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Client 00:24:23
Do you have evidence that Didero helped you stay on top of all these shifting movements and avoid delays and all of that? Is it very clear to you that it's been helpful and that it works as an insurance policy, or you're not sure yet?

Expert 00:24:36
Not as an official insurance policy.

---

Client 00:24:39
You know what I mean? They're not going to reimburse you.

Expert 00:24:44
I think everyone agrees on that. Everyone on my team agrees that it does.

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Client 00:24:50
Okay. Can you give me a rough ballpark of how much you're spending on Didero?

Expert 00:24:56
Yeah, we spend about $30,000-$60,000 a year.

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Client 00:25:01
Got it. I think the math there is like, the consultant is already paying for Didero basically because it's $120,000 versus $30,000-$60,000. Let's say that your company takes off and you have a much bigger, I don't know, supplier base that you need to manage, is your sense that Didero could handle greater complexity or you think it's a nice tool for now, but **you'd be skeptical** about how it can scale?


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Expert 00:25:29
No, I definitely think we will use it as we scale. We started using it in our clinical trial one. Didero is one of the first things we onboard everyone on.

Client 00:25:39
Okay. I'll explain to you what it means if you don't know. How mission critical would you say that Didero is to your day-to-day operations?

Expert 00:25:50
At this point, I would say an eight out of 10. If it went down for a day, I think we could survive. More than a day, it would be difficult. We'd have to hire consultants again and then I don't even know how they would learn the processes from Didero.

Client 00:26:07
Got it. Similar question, but slightly different. My question is, so you've been using Didero since when, March? You said you went live in March.

Expert 00:26:18
Correct.

Client 00:26:19
You've been using Didero for six months or so. Imagine that **a Didero competitor** came along with a similar product that does a similar job, how easy would it be to switch?

Expert 00:26:29
Yeah. I think the whole integrated process is really fast, so maybe it is easy to switch that way. However, it's the automation and the suggesting that's personalized in there already, that I don't know how to move.

Client 00:26:43
Is your sense that Didero have gotten better over time as **you've used it, or has stayed the same or has gotten worse in terms of the suggestions and stuff**?

Expert 00:26:53
I think it's gotten better because we still get new suggestions even though we don't really add new processes. It just picks up on new things that we do. It has the phonological data.

Client 00:27:06
Got it. One other question I have is, you mentioned early on that you demoed Prendio, **you were disappointed** because they were claiming that they were using AI, but it was actually all humans behind the scenes. Are the suggestions you're getting from Didero real time, or is there a delay? Do you think there's a human behind them or do they seem machine-driven?

Expert 00:27:28
That's a really good question. They're right away, so I think they're machine-driven. I send the email and then it pops up with the suggestions. That means it's AI, not a human.

Client 00:27:39
Got it. Do you have a sense of the number of orders you guys do in a given year or quarter or month from your suppliers?

Expert 00:27:47
It depends. I think recurringly, we do like 15 orders a month, just on recurring supplies and then on one-off supplies, maybe like 20 a month, 50 a month total.


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Client 00:28:00

Sorry, 20+15 is 35. Did I get it wrong?

Expert 00:28:06

No, 20+30.

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Client 00:28:10

Okay, so 30 a month of recurring or 30 a mount of one-off?

Expert 00:28:15

Sorry, 15 a month of recurring. You're right, 15 recurring and then 20 one-off, so it'd be 35.

---

Client 00:28:23

Got it. I want to make sure my math is not wrong. Another question, maybe you don't know and it's totally fine, but I'm curious if you're aware as to other biotech companies, not yours, but similar companies to yours, do they face similar pain and do they have systems for it, or are you guys an exception that maybe you have a super small team and you have this unique need?

Expert 00:28:46

No. It's very common. It's the biggest form of delays. CROs, the longer it takes for your trial because of delays, the more they charge you. Contract research organizations are a great business model. We always joke about that.

---

Client 00:29:03

Super helpful. Are there things you wish Didero could do that it doesn't do yet? Have you requested any features or capabilities? Have they shared with you the roadmap?

Expert 00:29:15

I haven't thought about that and I've never asked them for anything. I'm usually just a very passive customer. I'm just impressed with things that pop up.

---

Client 00:29:25

Got it. I want to go back to the point you made about helping you get goods across borders. Could you unpack that a bit, walk me through maybe a real example that's happened to you? What did Didero do concretely to help you there?

Expert 00:29:41

Yeah. **We had an active ingredient stuck at the Canadian-U.S. border** and we did not know why it was stuck. Usually, we had our consultant who is a customs broker. Basically, they're physically based there and they go and try to physically find the product. When we had Didero, basically they realized that **it was stuck**. They basically notified us that **it's been stalled at the border for a while**.

It populated customs brokers that they knew, and they were like, "Would you like us to draft an email to that?" They drafted an email to them and I just press send. It stole a stock after a few hours. I just pressed send the drafts of the other two to the customs brokers, and within a day, it crossed the border.

---

Client 00:30:24

Didero, first of all, identify you had these active ingredients stuck at the border and then it suggested who you should email?

Expert 00:30:33

Yeah. These are people we've never emailed before. They just have their own contact list of people who help things stuck at the border.

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Client 00:30:43
Got it. Did you have to pay these people to help you get the goods across or how did it work?

Expert 00:30:51
Yes, we had to pay them.

---

Client 00:30:54
Okay. You emailed them and said, "Hey, my goods are stuck, can you help me?" They responded to you or how did it work?

Expert 00:31:05
Yeah, they responded with a rate. It's based on success also. We wouldn't have to pay for all three. The first time I sent this price, we were like, "Okay. It didn't work." We paid for the other two people and one of them got us through, so we only paid for one.

---

Client 00:31:23
Super interesting. You basically had some contract in place with these brokers in the sense of that you said, "If you help me, I will pay you on a success fee." You ended up paying these brokers.

Expert 00:31:36
Yes. We had no idea who these brokers were prior to it getting stuck. I think that was really interesting.

---

Client 00:31:43
It worked.

Expert 00:31:45
It worked, yes. It also happens with procurement. Sometimes we can't find an ingredient. We have a research associate who spent three days looking for this curcumin, specific curcumin product. She spent three days and found two suppliers. We put it into Didero. We just emailed our Didero customer success because they said they could help with supply chain, but we didn't know how to input it into the system. The customer success person emailed back within a few hours, 10 different suppliers that were all better than what my research associate found. That's not in the platform.

---

Client 00:32:20
Sorry, who emailed you back?

Expert 00:32:22
Customer success person.

---

Client 00:32:24
Okay, at Didero?

Expert 00:32:27
At Didero, yeah.

---

Client 00:32:30
Got it. In the tasks view, whenever it makes a suggestion, is there a way you can tell Didero **this was a bad suggestion** or I don't want to do this?

Expert 00:32:40
Yeah. I would say 10% of the time I don't turn it into a process. Maybe I'll just use the email because I don't want it to be automated. I want it still be a touch system where I decide whether we send it or not. I feel that happens 10% of the time.


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Client 00:33:00

Got it. By the way, whenever you guys initially integrated Didero, did **you have any concerns** about like, "Gosh, these guys are going to see all of our emails," or you didn't really care?

Expert 00:33:11

We had our attorneys look over their data privacy stuff.

Client 00:33:16

Got it. You mentioned this example of the customer success person who helped you find suppliers for whatever thing you needed to buy. Is that a feature that you wished you had on the platform or you don't really care?

Expert 00:33:28

I'm just happy it works like, I can email. I don't think I really care if it's in the platform or not. I think it'd be cool if it was like a ChatGPT thing because right now, I can type in last document from X supplier, but I can't be like, what are their better suppliers than this specific one? It'd be cool if they added like a ChatGPT thing. I feel like everyone's adding these things.

Client 00:33:52

Got it. By the way, how often do you interact with the customer success team at Didero?

Expert 00:33:59

Once every three weeks, very rarely.

Client 00:34:02

Got it. Do you have a sense of the volume of emails that Didero handles for you on a weekly basis or a monthly basis like ballpark?

Expert 00:34:11

Let's see, maybe like 500.

Client 00:34:14

Per what?

Expert 00:34:16

Sorry, 500 per week. I'm assuming a little over 60 X eight.

Client 00:34:22

Got it. I know that you guys only signed in March of this year, was it a one-year contract or did you sign a longer contract? Do you know?

Expert 00:34:31

One-year contract.

Client 00:34:33

Got it. Do you think you would renew it or do you not have a view?

Expert 00:34:39

No, we would 100% renew this contract.



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Client 00:34:43

Got it. I think I have one final question. On a scale from 1-10, how likely would you recommend them to a friend or a colleague?

Expert 00:34:52

Who, me, not just random people?

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Client 00:34:55

Yeah, of course.

Expert 00:34:57

Okay. Probably a nine.

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Client 00:34:59

Okay. Why not a 10? What is missing?

Expert 00:35:04

I don't have a really good sense of ERPs and tech stacks. I feel like every time I recommend software, they're like, "Does it integrate with this?" I'm like, "I don't really know."

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Client 00:35:18

Got it. Thank you so much. This was really, really helpful. We'll definitely follow up if we have more questions. Really appreciate it. **It definitely sounds like a pretty impressive product**.



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